of his first name, in Polish.)

"Asimov?" he said, wondering.

"Stash," I said, spreading my arms wide, "I love you."

Whereupon he jumped up tensely, threw himself into a posture of self-defense, and said, "You try to hug me and I knock you down."

I was helped into my cot and someone pulled some of my clothes off me and I lay giggling there all night. It was the only day in the Army in which I was truly happy. I guess that's why people drink. 6

I had no reason to be proud of this experience of drunkenness. The others easily outstripped me. On April 27, the other specialists all got drunk for some reason or other. Upton, who had the bed next to mine, lay there hiccuping and slowly and repetitively protesting his love for me.

"Yes, Ed," I kept saying, soothingly, and then I recited for him, dramatically:

The love of a man for his brother And the love of a child for its mother Are nothing at all compared to the love Of one drunken bum for another.

6 1 balanced the Passover celebration by spending Easter Sunday, the twenty-6rst, at a Lutheran Church with a couple of Protestant soldiers. I sang the hymns lustily.

Upton listened carefully and nodded and said, "That's right. That's right." Then he leaned over the side of the bed (the far side, thank goodness) threw up, and went to sleep.

10

On April 30, we left our barracks, in which I had stayed forty-six days, and moved onto the Cortland, a ship in the harbor. It would take us to Bikini.

I was sorry to leave the barracks, for I had spent a quite tolerable time there despite my separation from Gertrude. I was also sorry to leave the other specialists (after two months of close association), for they were distributed among other ships.

On that day, too, I completed my first half year in the Army and I was rather astonished I had survived it as well as I had. I hadn't even gotten into trouble